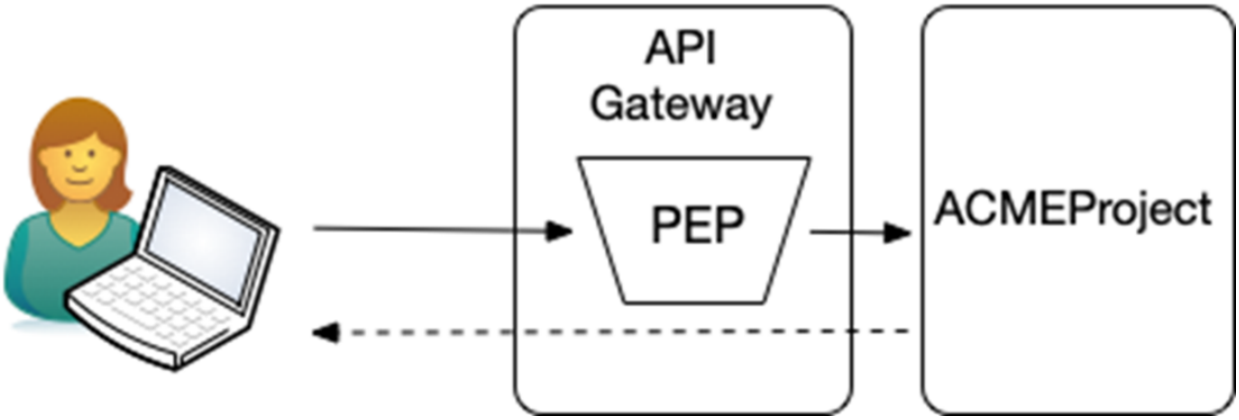


Figure 4.4 The Policy Enforcement Point (PEP) deployed in an API gateway. In this model, the PEP sits in front of ACMEProject, intercepting and evaluating access requests before they reach the application. This approach centralizes enforcement and simplifies policy updates across multiple services.

Figure 4.5 shows the PEP deployed in a sidecar container alongside the application container within the same pod. This pattern, common in service mesh environments like Istio, enables fine-grained control over service-to-service communication without modifying the app itself. While Alice is shown accessing ACMEProject from outside, this sidecar pattern also applies to internal microservice-to-microservice requests, ensuring that authorization decisions are consistently enforced across components.

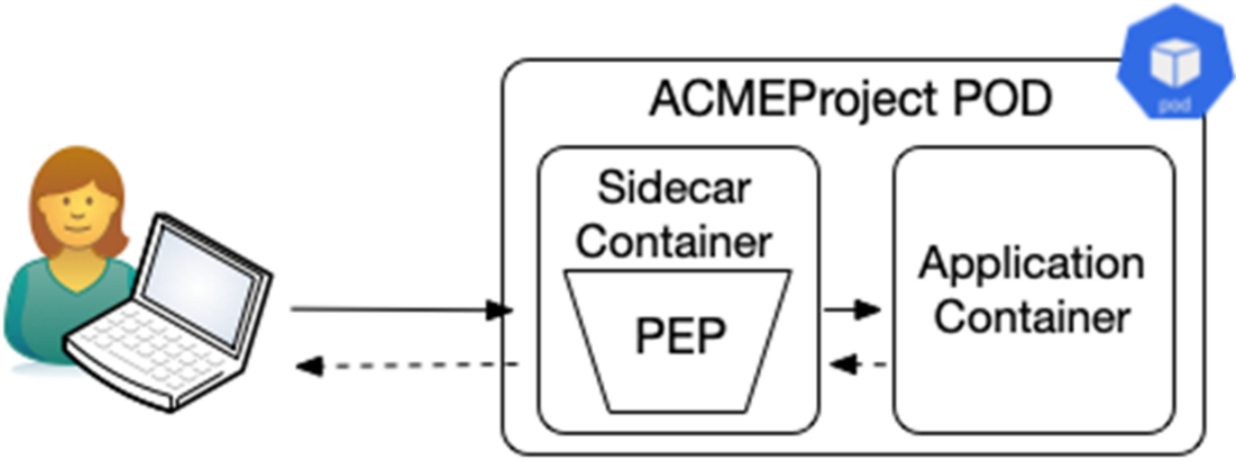


Figure 4.5 The Policy Enforcement Point (PEP) deployed as a sidecar. In this model, the PEP runs alongside the application, typically within the same container or virtual machine (VM). This approach ensures that policies are enforced locally at the service level, without altering the core application architecture.